

Samsung Galaxy S25 FE

A flagship-lite that finally gets the balance just right

I have been using Samsung smartphones since the brand dropped the Galaxy S4 Mini, and over the years, I have upgraded through some of its flagship – from Galaxy S8 to Galaxy S20 and most recently the Galaxy S23 Plus. What kept me loyal is Samsung's knack for delivering a perfect blend between powerful hardware, polished software and everyday ease of use.

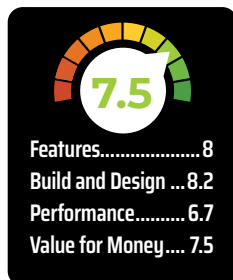
That's not all, over the years, Samsung has also built an entire ecosystem with its A, M, and F series across different price segments, but there was always a gap- a device that carries flagship traits without the flagship price tag. And in 2020, Samsung finally stepped in with the FE lineup and here we are in 2025 with the latest addition: the Samsung Galaxy S25 FE.

And this time, the Samsung fanboy in me- who once only aspired to own every flagship, finally gets to put the new S25 FE through its paces. Here's my take on whether Samsung's latest FE still nails that blend of value and performance.

DESIGN

The Galaxy S25 FE carries forward design signature Samsung's flagship lineup. Both the front and back are protected by Corning Gorilla Glass Victus Plus, while the frame uses the same enhanced Armor Aluminium found on the S25 and S25 Plus. It also keeps the IP68 rating, which has now become standard in this segment.

At 190 grams, the phone is lighter than the S24 FE, and that difference is noticeable in day-to-day handling. The slimmer weight makes it easier for longer stretches without feeling bulky.



Samsung offers the device in three shades: Navy, White, and Jet Black. We tested the Navy option, and while colour choice is subjective, it does stand out with a slightly more striking matte finish compared to the usual safe tones.

DISPLAY

If there's one area where Samsung rarely disappoints, it's displays- and the Galaxy S25 FE continues that tradition. The phone comes with a 6.7-inch LTPO AMOLED panel running at a 120Hz



refresh rate, and at first glance, it checks almost every box you'd expect from a device with Samsung's display DNA.

Our Calman tests with the SpectraCal C6 HDR2000 colorimeter gave an average DeltaE of only 1.5 (anything less than 2 is considered excellent), with a peak error of 2.8, indicating that colours appear strikingly accurate to the human eye. Add to that 99.7% gamut coverage and infinite contrast from the OLED panel, and you've got a screen that's nearly professional-grade.

In our brightness test, the panel hit an impressive 1950 nits peak brightness, which puts it right up there with some of the best in the segment. This means outdoor visibility is excellent, even under direct sunlight, the screen remains legible and vibrant.

That said, there's a small caveat: the resolution tops out at FHD+. At this price point, QHD+ resolution would have been the icing on the cake, but Samsung makes up for it by packing in HDR10+ support. This makes a big difference when streaming on Netflix or YouTube, where high dynamic range content looks vivid and immersive.

PERFORMANCE

Samsung has given the Galaxy S25 FE a good upgrade by switching to the Exynos 2400. On paper, that means a 10-core CPU (deca-core) with one heavyweight Cortex-X4 core running at 3.2GHz for raw power, a cluster of Cortex-A720 cores for balanced performance, and Cortex-A520 efficiency cores to handle lighter tasks without draining the battery. The phone is designed to balance brute force with efficiency, depending on what you're doing.

In everyday use, this approach pays off. Even if you are doomscrolling through social media, taking pictures on the go or juggling through demanding apps, the S25 felt pretty smooth. The kind of lag, which we are used to in premium mid-range phones is absent.

When pushed through benchmarks, the results back up that feeling. The phone scored 1,902,139 on AnTuTu, 2,193 (single-core) and 7,093 (multi-core) on